

SAYING GOODBYE...

For 80 years the television has graced our living rooms, kept us engrossed, informed and entertained. Sadly, its time is now done. We must now say goodbye to the old ways and usher in the modern world, or have we done that already? Let's find out.

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The days of the TV are numbered. It's been more than 80 years since the TV first entered our homes and it has lived a long and prosperous life; surviving on a symbiotic relationship of sorts, feeding the people the entertainment they want and living off the money they throw at it. The juggernaut that is the TV industry has been rolling along unhindered for decades, growing exponentially with no signs of slowing down. But now, finally, it's showing its age and is already an old-fashioned, wheezing platform that's on its last legs and is just one real revolution away from ceasing to exist.

How did this happen? What is bringing an industry, that's still valued in the trillions of dollars, grinding to a halt at such a pace? To understand that, we need to understand what we really want from TV and why we're not getting it.

So, first up, a quick history lesson to get you to grips with the TV industry.

Rewind

1930s-40s

The TV was introduced to the people. It was still black and white, very expensive and you couldn't really watch more than 15-20 channels. Broadcasters didn't have an idea of what to do with even those 20 channels in the first place.

1950s-70s

The television grew in popularity at an exponential rate. Advertisers started to appreciate the true potential of the TV and



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appreciated the ability to target over 200 million people right in their own homes. Also, it was in the 50s that the TV-guide became the no.1 magazine in the U.S.

The TV was the window to the outside world and even beyond it. Hundreds of millions of people witnessed man's first steps on the moon, many more witnessed JFK's assassination. If that wasn't enough, the 70s was the decade that saw the launch of the Atari Pong, the first, true video game console (and game) for the TV.

1980s-2000s

The 80s and 90s were the golden age of the sitcom, with shows like Cheers, Diff'rent Strokes; the 90s saw the birth

of Friends and Seinfeld. The early 2000s also saw the launch of more risqué content in shows such as The Sopranos and Sex in the City.

Most importantly however, there were two inventions that sneaked up from nowhere and almost turned the TV industry on its head. These two inventions were the forerunners to the revolution that the people were begging for. What were these inventions? The VCR and TiVo.

What's wrong with TV?

TiVo gave people the option to watch what they wanted, when they wanted it. Sitting between your TV and your cable